A-A-53950
28 July 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RACK, TEST TUBE, LABORATORY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as replacement for Military Specification MIL-R-37208 which will be cancelled.

This commercial item description covers corrosion-resistant steel wire racks for holding 90 glass hemagglutination test tubes for use in laboratory procedures.

Salient characteristics.

The test tube racks shall conform to style I or style II of DPSC Drawing 2031.

Racks shall be designed to accommodate 90 glass hemagglutination test tubes, 13 + 0.1, -0.5 millimeters (mm) in diameter by 75 mm long.

The racks shall consist of three frames. The top and middle frames shall each consist of 90 holes, arranged in six rows of 15 holes each. The bottom frame shall be a wire mesh for style I and a lattice for style II. For style I, the holes of the top and middle frames shall be aligned to hold the test tubes in a vertical position. For style II, the holes in the top and middle frame and the lattice of the bottom frame shall be aligned to hold the test tubes in a vertical position with the tubes resting on the lattice.

The steel wire shall conform to ASTM A-580, Composition type 302 or 304, Condition A.

All wire intersections and joints shall be spot welded except for the wire mesh of the bottom frame of style I racks. The spot welds shall be smooth and free of surface burning, cracks and porosity.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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Style I and style II racks shall have wire ends fastened to the frames either by welding the wire flat against the frame with no protruding points, or by crimping the wire tightly around the frame and welding so that there are no sharp or protruding ends.

Racks shall be tested to determine resistance to corrosion on all surfaces. Slight corrosion in small crevices shall not be reason for rejection.

The finished racks shall have a smooth, clean finish such as that produced by electropolishing, or equal.

Reference publications and drawings. The issue in effect on the date for invitation for bid or request for proposal, shall apply for all publications and drawings referenced in this specification.

Workmanship. The test tube racks shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One test tube rack, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for inspections and tests. Sampling for inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one test tube rack.

Inspections and tests. Inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-00-299-8490

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6640-1570

Location: CID/RACK/TEST/TUBE/S38/16

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